

Elaine (Yilin) Wang
she/her/hers
Department of Psychology, Yale University
100 College St, New Haven, CT 06510
elaineyilin.wang@yale.edu

EDUCATION

Yale University

Ph.D. Candidate (Advisor: Dr. Julia Leonard)

Expected Jun 2029

M.Sc. in Psychology

Jan 2026

M.Phil in Psychology

Jan 2026

University of Toronto

Honours B.Sc.

Jun 2023

Psychology, Neuroscience, Physiology

Independent project: *The effect of effort-reward inconsistency on persistence in preschool children*

Advisor: Dr. Jessica Sommerville

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS & FELLOWSHIPS

Conference Travel Fund: \$800

2026

Graduate School of Arts & Science, Yale University

Conference Travel Fund: \$700

2025

Graduate School of Arts & Science, Yale University

Conference Travel Fund: \$800

2024

Graduate School of Arts & Science, Yale University

Education Studies Grant: \$5000

2024

Education Studies Program, Yale University

The McNab Scholarship In Psychology: \$800

2023

Department of Psychology, University of Toronto

Ethel Treble and F. Louis Barber Travelling Scholarship: \$2700

2023

Victoria College, University of Toronto

Victoria College Postgraduate Scholarship: \$2500

2023

Victoria College, University of Toronto

George Mandler Research Fund: \$700

2022

Department of Psychology, University of Toronto

NSERC Undergraduate Research Award: \$7500 <i>Department of Psychology, University of Toronto</i>	2022
Dr. Lorus J. And Dr Margery J. Milne Scholarship: \$5000 <i>Victoria College, University of Toronto</i>	2022
Salvatore and Marion (Cooper) Brancaccio Scholarship: \$1000 <i>Victoria College, University of Toronto</i>	2022
Karl S. Bernhardt Scholarship: \$1000 <i>Victoria College, University of Toronto</i>	2021
Teça Patricia (Court) Coles Scholarship: \$1000 <i>Victoria College, University of Toronto</i>	2020
Dean's List Scholar, Faculty of Arts & Science <i>Faculty of Arts & Science, University of Toronto</i>	2020 - 2023

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Wang, E., Shachnai, R., & Leonard, J.A. (2026). *Overparenting shapes how children learn about the self from social comparison.* Talk presented at the Cognitive Science Society, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil.

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2026). *Children integrate diverse social signals to infer the value of effort during performance plateaus.* Talk presented at the Cognitive Development Society, Montreal, CAN.

Wang, E., Shachnai, R., & Leonard, J.A. (2025). *Hidden costs of overparenting: Children feel worse about their abilities when adults take over for their peers.* Talk presented at the Cognitive Science Society, San Francisco, CA.

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2025). *Preschoolers persist more when effort-based messages align with effort-based rewards.* Talk presented at the Society for Research in Child Development, Minneapolis, MN.

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2024) *Practice what you preach: Consistent messages about the value of effort foster children's persistence.* Cognitive Development Society, Pasadena, CA.

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., & Sommerville, J.A. (2023). *Practice what you preach: Children persist less when values and reward structures are inconsistent.* Flash talk presented at the Society for Research in Child Development, Salt Lake City, UT.

Wang, E. (2022). *Practice what you preach: Children persist less when values and reward structures are inconsistent*. Talk presented at the Psychology Undergraduate Research Club at the University of Toronto, Toronto, ON.

Radovanovic, M., Soldovieri, A., Solby, H., **Wang, E.**, Vorvis, J., Shirvani, J., & Sommerville, J.A. (2022). *Autonomy in problem-solving: Prioritizing exploration relates to increased persistence*. Talk presented at the International Congress on Infant Studies, Ottawa, ON.

CONFERENCE POSTERS

⁺Indicates undergraduate mentee

* Indicates equal contribution

Wang, E., Shachnai, R. & Leonard, J.A. (2026). *Overparenting leads peers to form negative self-beliefs*. Poster presented at Cognitive Development Society, Montreal, CAN.

Umaña, L.R.⁺, **Wang, E.***, Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2026). *Stakes reduce children's optimism about their abilities*. Poster presented at Yale University Undergraduate Research Conference, New Haven, CT.

Umaña, L.R.⁺, **Wang, E.**, Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2026). *Stakes reduce children's optimism about their abilities*. Poster presented at Yale University Undergraduate Research Conference, New Haven, CT.

Umaña, L.R.⁺, **Wang, E.**, Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2025). *Expecting less when it matters more: Children's optimism decreases in high-stakes environments*. Poster presented at Wu Tsai Undergraduate Fellowship Symposium, New Haven, CT.

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2024). *Preschoolers persist more when effort-based messages align with effort-based rewards*. Poster presented at Curiosity, Information Seeking & Exploration Conference, Providence, RI.

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2024). *Practice what you preach: Consistent messages about the value of effort foster children's persistence*. Poster presented at Cognitive Science Society, Rotterdam, NL.

Matorina, N., **Wang, E.**, Guliyev, J., Barense, M.B. (2023). *The contextualization of recent and remote autobiographical memories*. Poster presented at the Cognitive Neuroscience Society, San Francisco, CA.

INVITED TALKS

Social Learning Lab, Stanford University

2026

Writing about Science, Medicine, and the Environment, Yale College	2025
Levari Lab, Brown University	2025
Writing about Science, Medicine, and the Environment, Yale College	2024
Research Rounds, Yale Center for Emotional Intelligence	2024

PUBLICATIONS

Wang, E., Shachnai, R., & Leonard, J.A. (2025). Hidden costs of overparenting: Children feel worse about their abilities when adults take over for their peers. *Proceedings of the 47th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*.

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., Sommerville, J., & Leonard, J.A. (2024). Practice what you preach: Consistent messages about the value of effort foster children's persistence. *Proceedings of the 46th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*.

Jung, K., Meleca, S., Suhan, S., Tan, A., **Wang, E.** & Babineau, M. (2022). *Expect the unexpected: Studying language acquisition in small-scale societies*. International Congress on Infant Studies Baby Blog.

IN PREPARATION

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (under review). Preaching effort, rewarding performance: How conflicting social signals shape children's persistence.

Wang, E., Shachnai, R. & Leonard, J.A. (in prep). Overparenting shapes how children learn about the self from social comparison.

TEACHING

Graduate Writing Lab Fellow Poorvu Teaching and Learning Center, Yale University	2026 - Present
Teaching Fellow Research Methods Writing Intensive, Yale University	2026 - Present
Teaching Fellow Developmental Psychology, Yale University	Fall 2025

Teaching Fellow
Research Methods Writing Intensive, Yale University

Spring 2025

Teaching Fellow
The Criminal Mind, Yale University

Fall 2024

CAMPUS & COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

Community Engagement Community Co-Chair **2024 - Present**
Department of Psychology, Yale University

Mentor **2023 - 2024**
Sneak Peek Mentorship Program, Yale University

Mentor **2022 - 2023**
Psychology Students' Association, University of Toronto

Secretary-General **2022 - 2023**
North American Model United Nations, University of Toronto

Translator
COVID Speaks **2021 - 2021**

Leader **2020 - 2021**
Victoria College Orientation, University of Toronto

Mentor **2020 - 2021**
UniFind, University of Toronto

Mentor **2019 - 2020**
Academic Success Center, University of Toronto

SKILLS

RStudio, Datavyu, JASP, Microsoft Office Suite, iMovie, Level-1 MRI Training, FMRIB
Software Library, SPSS, Squarespace

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Cognitive Science Society, Society for Research in Child Development, Cognitive Development
Society